

Metropolitan Community College Email Acceptable Use Policy

1. Purpose

The Acceptable Use Policy outlines appropriate and secure use of Metropolitan Community College's (MCC) email system. The policy ensures protection from cyber-attacks, namely phishing, and confidentiality, integrity, and availability of MCC data.

2. Scope

The policy applies to all faculty, staff, administrators, contractors, students, and any other individuals who are provided access to the MCC's email system.

3. Acceptable Use

3.1 Normal Uses

- MCC email accounts are to be utilized primarily for academic, administrative, and research-related purposes supporting the mission of the College.
- Moderate personal use is permitted so long as it does not interfere with MCC operations, result in additional costs, or violate any MCC policies.

3.2 Prohibited Uses

- Commercialization or personal business use of MCC email is prohibited.
- Forging emails.
- Bulk emails for non-College purposes or any use that would bring MCC into disrepute are not allowed.

4. Security Requirements

4.1 Attachments and Links

- Users should exercise caution when opening email attachments or following links from unknown or suspicious senders.
- Automatic downloading of attachments should be disabled unless from confirmed, trusted sources.
- All email traffic may be subject to scanning by College-approved antivirus and anti-malware software.

4.2 Sender Validation

- Users are prompted to verify the identity of unknown senders before replying or opening links and attachments.
- All suspicious emails must be sent to the MCC Information Technology Office immediately.

4.3 Encryption and Confidentiality

- Users are advised not to send sensitive information via email unless necessary.
- If sensitive, confidential, or personally identifiable information (PII), like employee data or student records, must be emailed, the email must be encrypted.
- Applicable laws and College policies that must be followed include:
 - Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA)
 - Payment Card Industry Data Security Standards (PCI-DSS)
 - [Red Flag Rule - Identity Theft Prevention Program PM X-30](#)
 - Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA)

- Gramm-Leach-Bliley ACT
- Nebraska Data-Security Law

4.4 Use of Digital Signatures

- Faculty and staff must use approved digital signatures to verify the authenticity of their communications.

5. Email Retention

- All College emails must be retained per the MCC's Record Retention Policy.
- Users may not delete emails on legal hold or under investigation.

6. Remote and Mobile Access

6.1 Authorized Access

- Remote access to MCC email systems is permitted only via College-approved devices and secure connections (e.g., VPN).
- Mobile access to MCC email will meet the College-approved devices, software, and minimum security settings.

6.2 Time and Location Restrictions

- Using high-risk public networks, such as coffee shops and malls, is not advisable and may be rejected.
- Automatic session timeout after 15 minutes of inactivity will be enforced for web-based email access.

6.3 Personally Owned Devices

- Personal devices may access College email, so long as they meet the security requirements, such as up-to-date antivirus software, full-disk encryption, and strong passwords.

7. Privacy and Monitoring

- Users should have **no expectation of privacy** when using the College's email system.
- The College reserves the right to monitor and log all email activity for security, legal, and operational purposes.

8. Unauthorized Access

- Sharing account credentials, leaving sessions active on shared devices, or permitting unauthorized individuals (including family members) to access College email is strictly prohibited.
- Access violations may be subject to disciplinary action.

9. Penalties for Misuse

Violations of this policy may result in:

- Revocation of email access
- Disciplinary action up to and including dismissal
- Referral to law enforcement where appropriate